WEEKLY

Weekly World Events Intel — week ending 2026-10-25

DTG 251530 CDT OCT 26
PERIOD 2026-10-19 to 2026-10-25

weekly intel world-events US-impact economy Minnesota-costs Iran Hormuz IRGC UKMTO 181-26 CENTCOM Cooper USS-George-Washington Theodore-Roosevelt 13th-MEU DNI travel-advisory ordered-departure Gem-No-2 UAE-oil-spill OFAC Houthis Saudi-Arabia Riyadh Dammam Yanbu East-West-pipeline Egypt Mecca-pact oil Brent housing-starts jobless-claims PMI UMich DPA FOMC Russia Ukraine Witkoff Putin Abu-Dhabi-talks Hubbard Oleshky Graham-Act-waiver Starshield Ilhan-Omar Minnesota Klobuchar Demuth Renee-Good Alex-Pretti DOJ Ninth-Circuit Alaska-lawsuit midterms Israel-election Netanyahu

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WEEKLY WORLD EVENTS INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

ARCHIVE NOTE: This weekly synthesizes daily/2026-10-19 through daily/2026-10-25 plus a fresh 25 OCT afternoon cross-check. The week's headline: no US strike on Iran, but the strike question moved from "after the election" talk to physical preparation. The New York Times, NPR, ABC, and the FT reported US and Israeli plans for renewed strikes after the 03 NOV midterms. The third carrier (USS Theodore Roosevelt) and the 13th MEU are inbound, and USS George Washington was filmed loading GBU-31 bunker-busters. The Hill reports CENTCOM strike options have been presented to Hegseth. Trump's language swung from "We could leave right now" (19 OCT) to "we're not negotiating" (21 OCT), "another little Epic Fury" (23 OCT), "maybe tomorrow" (24 OCT), and on Sunday 25 OCT "do I make a deal with them, or do I finish them off?" followed by "There will not be a strike today." The White House's no-strike-before-03 NOV pledge still stands, though Ambassador Barrack said a weekend strike was "Absolutely" possible. Tehran's line is split: Pezeshkian says Iran must "go and finish" a deal and Baghaei says messages still pass through intermediaries, while Araghchi says Hormuz management "will no longer be the same" and the armed forces chief vows no US warships in the Gulf. At sea, UKMTO went from 177-26 to 181-26 (three confirmed tanker hits on 20–22 OCT plus one advisory). The IRGC claimed at least 13 ships hit or mined this week, none named, and Trump and CENTCOM called the claims fake. A spill from the tanker Gem No. 2 (hit 09 OCT) closed UAE beaches. Force protection tightened: ordered departure from Saudi Arabia, staff cuts at four more embassies, a DNI memo warning Iranian plots to kill Americans have reached "advanced stages," quiet US base drawdowns, and updated travel advisories for 13–14 regional countries. The Houthi–Saudi war intensified: deaths at Dammam airport and from debris at Shaybah, Aramco's Dhahran HQ evacuated, missiles toward Riyadh, Taif, and Yanbu, and a Houthi claim of new strikes on Riyadh airport hours after it reopened on 25 OCT. Oil: Brent settled $116.72 on Friday (+6.2% on the week, highest since 29 APR). Data: housing starts −5.2%, claims 194,000, flash PMI 57.6 with the fastest price rises since 2022, and UMich sentiment 48.0. The S&P 500 fell 0.5% on the week. Russia–Ukraine: Witkoff met Putin, Russia freed American Stephen Hubbard, Abu Dhabi talks are set around 10 NOV, Russia hit Kyiv with 21 missiles, and the Oleshky ceasefire starts 27 OCT. Minnesota: still no charges against Rep. Omar, but the DOJ "Ilhan Nur Said Elmi" filing became a national campaign fight and Trump called for her resignation. MN regular $4.1991 / diesel $6.2199 (AAA 25 OCT); debt $40.444T (22 OCT).

KEY JUDGMENTS

1. A renewed US (and Israeli) strike campaign on Iran after 03 NOV is now the base case in reporting, not a fringe scenario. Force flow, munitions loading, published plans, and the President's own words all point to a decision window opening in early November. The no-strike-before-03 NOV pledge is the only public brake, and Trump keeps qualifying it day by day (MODERATE-HIGH).

2. Hormuz is a lull with high risk, not a reopening. Confirmed hits are fewer than Iran claims, but AIS-visible crossings remain at single digits per day against a prewar baseline near 85, and Brent rose all week. A resumed US campaign would likely draw Iranian attacks on the Gulf airports, pipelines, cables, and bases it has named (MODERATE-HIGH).
3. The Houthi campaign against Saudi Arabia is now the main threat to the Hormuz bypass (East-West pipeline to Yanbu, about 7 million bpd per Aramco) and a direct risk to Americans in the kingdom. A US decision on striking the Houthis remains open (MODERATE).
4. US inflation pressure is rising, not easing, into the 27–28 OCT FOMC. The flash PMI shows the fastest selling-price rises since 2022, housing is at multi-year lows with mortgage rates above 7%, and consumers are gloomy. A hold is expected; the debate is over December (MODERATE-HIGH).
5. The Russia track gives the administration a pre-election diplomatic story (Hubbard's release, Abu Dhabi talks, Oleshky), but Moscow has conceded only process while US sanctions relief (Graham Act waiver, Russian diesel) has drawn bipartisan criticism (MODERATE).
6. The Omar case is now a campaign weapon on both sides and remains uncharged. DOJ asked for until 09 NOV on unsealing, so no court record is likely before the election unless DOJ breaks its 60-day practice (MODERATE).

ITEM 1: Iran strike track and diplomacy — post-midterm strike plans reported; Trump from "leave right now" to "finish them off"; "no strike today"; Iran mixes deal signals with Hormuz defiance (Significance: HIGH)

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

18–25 OCT Washington / Tehran / Islamabad / Moscow / Jerusalem. Sun 18 OCT Trump posted that "unless they change their ways, rapidly, we will soon finish the job" and endorsed Netanyahu; Araghchi replied "Want to try your luck again? Be our guest. But be careful; we have unfinished jobs too." Mon 19 OCT at a Kansas rally Trump said "We could leave right now. They're not going to have a nuclear weapon"; Lavrov arrived in Tehran, his first visit of the war, to prevent "the return of a large-scale war." Tue 20 OCT Baqaei: "The era of hit-and-run attacks is over" and any strike would be answered "in equal measure, if not more forcefully"; Pakistan's army chief Munir arrived in Tehran and was told there would be no talks until Iran's conditions are met; Rezaei: "Not a single gram of enriched uranium will be removed from Iran." Trump in the Oval Office: high gas prices are "a small price to pay for not letting Iran have a nuclear weapon"; deputy press secretary Anna Kelly: "The United States will not be attacking Iran at any time prior to the midterm elections." Reuters (Hafezi, three senior Iranian officials) reported Tehran is deliberately prolonging talks to weaken Trump before 03 NOV. Wed–Thu 21–22 OCT: the NYT reported US and Israeli plans for renewed strikes after the midterms; NPR (a person briefed) said Israel wanted to strike in mid-October, Trump objected, and US forces are massing to be ready by early November; Trump at Joint Base Andrews: "No, I think we're not negotiating. We are going to have something one way or the other that'll happen fairly soon. Most people seem to think it's after the election." Putin told Witkoff Russia would be "glad to help" (Kremlin transcript). Thu 22–23 OCT: the FT (three sources) reported the IDF was ready to strike on the weekend of 10 OCT and Trump opposed it before the midterms; Netanyahu called the report "biased and untrue." ABC (two Israeli sources) reported joint plans discussed during Hegseth's unannounced 19 OCT Israel visit, with targets including petrochemical facilities and Pickaxe Mountain; one source: "Hunting season is open as soon as the elections end." Fri 23 OCT on the South Lawn Trump said "Do we want to finish it off or do we just want to let it wither?" and "We could take the whole country"; at Fort Myers, "We may do another little Epic Fury, or they'll agree." Ambassador Tom Barrack (no direct Iran role): "Could there be a strike this weekend? Absolutely." UN Ambassador Waltz told the FT the war could still be going in 12 months. Araghchi said Pezeshkian will meet Putin in Moscow next week. Sat 24 OCT after voting early, Trump said "we're thinking about doing it, and maybe tomorrow," but there is "also a possibility we'll have a nice, big, beautiful agreement"; The Hill reported CENTCOM follow-up strike options have been presented to Hegseth. Pezeshkian on state TV: "we have

to go and finish it" on a deal, admitting many Iranians struggle to afford food; Iran's ambassador to Pakistan told AP Iran would reopen Hormuz if the US lifts the blockade, which state media then denied; IRGC spokesman Mohebbi called US threats "largely for media consumption." Sun 25 OCT (fresh): Trump on Fox's "Sunday Morning Futures": "Now, my question is, do I make a deal with them, or do I finish them off?"; later, asked about a strike, "No. There will not be a strike today" (AP via CBS). Araghchi: "Whether there is war or not, our policies remain the same" and Hormuz management "will no longer be the same." Baghaei told a German broadcaster that Tehran has not closed the diplomatic window and messages pass to the US via intermediaries, rejecting "complete surrender" (state media via AP/CBS). Al Jazeera's live page headlines Qatari mediators in Tehran (body not retrieved). Ghalibaf said the US is in a "quagmire" (Al Jazeera) and urged Iranians to cut gas use by 10% ahead of winter. Netanyahu, in a video ahead of Israel's 27 OCT vote: "We have intelligence signs that our enemies, Iran and its proxies, could challenge us with attacks in order to disrupt the elections… Don't test us." Senate Democrats (Warren and four others) asked Adm. Cooper to publish war-cost and base-damage estimates; the Pentagon's last public figure was $46.3 billion (03 SEP, via Fox).

US IMPACT ASSESSMENT

Every concrete indicator this week (plans, force flow, munitions, the President's own framing) points to a decision window opening right after 03 NOV, with Israel's 27 OCT result as an input. The pledge and Trump's "not today" keep the next eight days nominally quiet, but Barrack's remark and "maybe tomorrow" show the pledge is not a hard constraint. Iran's split messaging (deal openings from Pezeshkian, Baghaei, and the Pakistan channel versus Araghchi and the armed forces on Hormuz) makes a pre-election diplomatic exit unlikely. A resumed campaign would expose US forces, Gulf bases, and oil prices at the same time.

SOURCE SYNOPSIS

Truth Social archive; Factba.se/Roll Call gaggle transcript (24 OCT); White House pool reports; NYT via Anadolu/Investing.com; NPR (22–23 OCT); ABC News; FT via EA WorldView/Times of Israel and CBS; The Hill (24 OCT); Reuters (Hafezi 20 OCT; South Lawn); Kremlin transcript (21 OCT); CBS live updates with AP/AFP (18–25 OCT, incl. fresh 25 OCT); Al Jazeera live (25 OCT, headline/summary); Fars; Tasnim; Iran International; Fox News Digital; USA Today via Fox.

MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)

Fox led with Trump's "decimated" claim, the carrier rearming (Trey Yingst aboard George Washington), and the "deal or finish them off" choice; Fox and the administration framed high gas prices as worth paying to stop an Iranian bomb. Glenn Beck (20 OCT) credited Trump with "unleash[ing] American energy" but conceded "higher fuel costs are squeezing household budgets." TheBlaze mostly posted rally clips rather than strike analysis; Daily Wire's 25 OCT District Club said Trump is making the midterms "more of his problem than he needed to." No S2 Underground, Timcast, or Crowder Iran strike coverage was found.

MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)

The NYT, NPR, and ABC led on post-midterm planning and the political timing; AP framed rising "fears of a return to war" before both countries' elections and humanized Iranians stockpiling food and medicine; Reuters framed Iran's stalling as aimed at a president with record-low approval over gas prices; CBS stressed that Barrack has no Iran role.

CONFIDENCE

HIGH on all quoted statements (transcripts, on-camera, primary posts). HIGH that multiple outlets report post-midterm strike planning; MODERATE on plan details and targets (anonymous sources; White House "may or may not exist"). MODERATE on The Hill's CENTCOM options report. HIGH that no US strike occurred this week. LOW on the Qatari mediator report (headline only; conflicting Iranian outlets earlier in the week).

ITEM 2: Hormuz and Gulf shipping — UKMTO 178–181-26; IRGC claims at least 13 ships, none named; Trump: "fake hits"; Gem No. 2 spill closes UAE beaches; traffic still a fraction of normal (Significance: HIGH)

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

18–25 OCT Strait of Hormuz, Arabian Gulf, Gulf of Oman. UKMTO products this week: Advisory 178-26 (19 OCT, a tanker "subject to interaction as part of ongoing military activity" about 121 NM east of Duqm, Oman); Warning 180-26 (time-late, tanker struck by an unknown projectile 30 NM southeast of Al Faw, Iraq, 1830 UTC 20 OCT, no damage); Warning 179-26 (tanker struck 11 NM west of Bukha, Oman, 0145 UTC 21 OCT, fire extinguished, crew safe); Warning 181-26 (dated 23 OCT; tanker hit by an unknown projectile 7 NM northeast of Limah, Oman, 1715 UTC 22 OCT, while outbound; it continued its voyage). None names the ship or attacker. No warning past 181-26 was found as of the fresh 25 OCT check. IRGC claims, all without names, flags, or UKMTO matches: a mined tanker (18 OCT); two tankers "set ablaze" (20 OCT); a supertanker with more than 2 million barrels (late 20 OCT); four vessels hit during "illegal" transfers in the northern Gulf plus three mined west of Hormuz, with a warning the conflict "will extend to its bases in the region" (22 OCT); two "violating" supertankers mined (24 OCT, confirmed as an IRGC claim by Xinhua). Trump (Truth Social, 22 OCT): Iran is "even making up fake hits, mines, and everything else, because more Oil is coming through the Hormuz Strait now than it did even prior to the beginning of the Conflict." A CENTCOM spokesperson told Al Jazeera the international lanes have been cleared of mines and 95 percent of vessels get through; IMO Secretary-General Dominguez told Fox "they still have mines" and "we cannot guarantee" a vessel will not hit one. Rubio (State transcript, 20 OCT): nightly traffic is "80 to 100 percent" of prewar and Iran is using "Nazi U-boat tactics." Fresh 25 OCT: Adm. Brad Cooper, flying over the strait, said more than 3,000 commercial vessels have transited with US military support over six months (AP via CBS). Counter-indicators: Kpler put Gulf crude at a seven-day average of about 8.5 million bpd in the week to 19 OCT (from more than 20 million the week before; Reuters); Kpler counts at least 18 vessels attacked in two weeks; the hormuz.now AIS tracker counted 5 commercial crossings on 24 OCT against a pre-crisis baseline of 84.8 a day (dark transits are not counted); Lloyd's List describes a night "dark shuttle" near Oman with AIS off and ship-to-ship transfers in the Gulf of Oman. Iranian state TV (23 OCT) claimed non-permitted traffic "has been completely stopped"; Maj. Gen. Abdollahi (24 OCT): "We will not allow U.S. military ships in the Persian Gulf under any circumstances and at any time." IRGC officials Javani and Mohebbi repeated threats to the "seven major cables" under the strait. Spill: the UAE closed Umm Al Quwain beaches (23 OCT) and Ras Al Khaimah closed all beaches (25 OCT); Orbital Risk Intelligence, the Conflict and Environment Observatory (slick about 160 sq km), and BBC Verify tie it to the tanker Gem No. 2, hit off the UAE on 09 OCT; the UAE has not named the ship. Aramco's CEO said East-West pipeline flows bypassing Hormuz rose from 2 million to 7 million bpd. Sanctions: on 21 OCT OFAC designated Roxette Maritime and seven Panama-flagged ships, the law firm Karnakis and Karnakis, Amigoz Singapore, and Dubai's Whales Shipping Line (EO 13902), with General License HH for wind-down through 20 NOV. Iraq closed its Al-Sheeb crossing with Iran on 21 OCT; two sources told AFP Washington wants more closures.

US IMPACT ASSESSMENT

The US and Iran now publish opposite accounts of the strait, and both are partly right: escorted volumes move, but at war-risk cost and with confirmed hits on the US-backed southern route (179-26, 181-26). Iran's "no US warships" line and threats to bases and cables are aimed straight at the escort mission. Brent's 6% weekly rise shows markets are pricing the risk regardless of claim counts. The Gem No. 2 spill adds an environmental cost for Gulf partners.

SOURCE SYNOPSIS

UKMTO 178–181-26 (primary notices; recent-incidents page via search 25 OCT); MSCIO Alert 153/26; State Department transcript (Rubio); Truth Social via CBS/Washington Times; Al Jazeera (CENTCOM spokesperson); Fox (IMO); AP via CBS (Cooper, 25 OCT); Reuters (Kpler,

	LSEG; Gem No. 2 analysts); hormuz.now AIS; Lloyd's List via AP; Maritime Executive; BBC Verify; The National; Euronews; OFAC recent actions (primary); Xinhua; Tasnim; RFE/RL.
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	Fox led with Rubio's "Nazi U-boat tactics," CENTCOM's "vast majority unsuccessful," and the IMO mine warning; the Washington Times led with Trump calling the claims fake. No Blaze, Daily Wire, Timcast, Crowder, or S2 Underground Hormuz coverage was found all week. Unsourced X posts claimed Hormuz would reopen "tomorrow" with gas at $2.50 (see quarantine).
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	AP and Al Jazeera called the seven-ship claim potentially the war's largest single-day toll "if confirmed" and stressed it could not be verified; Reuters and AFP led on attacks spreading beyond the strait; CBS and BBC led on the spill's damage near protected habitats.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on UKMTO texts (primary). HIGH that the IRGC made each claim; LOW that any occurred as described. HIGH on the Trump, Rubio, Abdollahi, and Cooper statements. MODERATE on flow figures (Kpler, AIS, Rubio, CENTCOM, and Aramco measure different things and conflict). MODERATE-HIGH on Gem No. 2 as the spill source.

ITEM 3: Threats to US personnel and force posture — ordered departure from Saudi Arabia; four more embassies cut; DNI memo on "advanced stages" plots; regional travel advisories; base drawdowns; third carrier inbound (Significance: HIGH)

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	19–25 OCT. Mon 19 OCT State issued a worldwide-style Middle East alert urging Americans to "exercise heightened vigilance" because Iran-backed groups "may target U.S. interests overseas." Wed 21 OCT State spokesman Tommy Pigott confirmed an ordered departure of non-emergency US government employees and families "in Saudi Arabia only." NBC and CBS reported the US military has quietly been reducing its footprint at Middle East bases because of Houthi and Iranian threats; CENTCOM said it routinely moves personnel to optimize readiness. Fri 23 OCT State said it will reduce staffing at the embassies in Jordan, Lebanon, Qatar, and the UAE (all already on "restricted operations"; they remain open; no ordered departure). The same day DNI Jay Clayton wrote to Secretary Rubio, in a one-page unclassified memo obtained by CBS and Axios, that "the lethal plotting efforts by the Iranians against U.S. citizens have reached advanced stages in both the Middle East and certain other countries"; it names no targets and does not say attacks are imminent, and a US official confirmed it is authentic (ABC). Sat 24 OCT State updated travel advisories for 13 or 14 regional countries (The National lists 13; CBS says 14) "to reflect the threat of Iranian-supported Houthi regional aggression"; Saudi Arabia is at "reconsider travel" with "Do not travel to the Yemen border," and the advisory warns attacks "have the potential to escalate rapidly beyond that immediate area." Force flow: the WSJ and NPR report USS Theodore Roosevelt (about a week out as of 23 OCT) and another Marine expeditionary unit are heading in; Al Jazeera reports about 10,000 more troops due by the end of November (these units left San Diego in late September; it is not a new order). WSJ and Fox crews aboard USS George Washington in the Arabian Sea filmed GBU-31 bunker-busters being loaded (24 OCT). Al Jazeera reports the Pentagon has confirmed 21 US service members killed in the region since the war began. Rubio said on 20 OCT that Saudi Arabia, Israel, and the US all want interceptors and "We have our own needs too." In the UK, police rearrested two men over the suspected 27 SEP Iranian-linked plot against RAF Fairford, the US-used bomber base. In Washington, suspicious packages near the Eisenhower Executive Office Building and the Ukrainian Embassy on 23 OCT were cleared.
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	In one week the government moved from a general alert to an ordered departure, embassy cuts, an intelligence warning about plots against Americans, and region-wide advisory changes. That is the posture of a government reducing exposure ahead of possible retaliation if strikes resume. Interceptor scarcity across Israel, the Gulf, and US bases (and Ukraine) is now an explicit constraint.

SOURCE SYNOPSIS	State Department statements and advisories (via Fox, CBS/AP, The National, Al-Monitor); CBS and Axios (DNI memo); ABC (authenticity); NBC and CBS (drawdowns); WSJ and NPR (carrier/MEU); WSJ/Fox reporting from USS George Washington; Al Jazeera; Fox 5 DC and The Hill (DC packages); Fox and Gulf News (Fairford).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	Fox carried the carrier rearming and framed Saudi defense gaps as something that "could soon become Trump's problem"; OSINTdefender amplified the WSJ "advanced stages" report. No Blaze, Daily Wire, Timcast, Crowder, or S2 Underground coverage of the memo or advisories was found.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	CBS and Axios tied the memo to the administration weighing renewed strikes; NBC framed the drawdowns as happening "as President Donald Trump weighs new military action in Iran"; Al-Monitor and CBS presented the advisories as a response to the Riyadh airport strike rather than new intelligence.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on the State actions, memo text, and authenticity. MODERATE on the advisory country count (13 vs 14). HIGH that base drawdowns are occurring (two networks); LOW on their scale. HIGH on the carrier and MEU movements.

ITEM 4: Houthi–Saudi war — Dammam and Shaybah deaths; Aramco evacuates Dhahran HQ; missiles toward Riyadh, Taif, Yanbu; Riyadh airport reopens and is targeted again; Egypt vote moved to 26 OCT (Significance: HIGH)

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

18–25 OCT Saudi Arabia / Yemen / Egypt / Turkey. Mon 19 OCT a Houthi missile strike on the al-Alam camp in Shabwa, Yemen, killed at least 20 (AP); the BBC later said more than 70 security personnel. Tue 20 OCT a ballistic missile toward Riyadh was intercepted and the coalition said it destroyed the launcher; the UK said RAF Typhoons will fly defensive counter-air missions over Saudi Arabia (MoD). Egypt's parliament adjourned the vote on authorizing forces for Saudi Arabia to 26 OCT (correcting earlier reports of a 20 OCT vote). Turkey sent the Mecca Joint Defense Agreement with Saudi Arabia and Pakistan to parliament. Wed 21 OCT an attack on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam killed two and injured eight (GACA), and debris from a drone aimed at Aramco's Shaybah field killed two; drones were also downed over Medina and the Eastern Province. Reuters (six sources) reported Aramco told staff to evacuate its Dhahran headquarters. Thu 22 OCT the Houthis claimed strikes on the Saudi Defense Ministry in Riyadh, Dammam and Abha airports, and an Aramco site at Yanbu (no Saudi confirmation); Dammam reopened. Fri 23 OCT missiles toward Riyadh and Khamis Mushait were intercepted; coalition and SPA figures put October at at least 14 ballistic missiles and more than 60 drones launched at the kingdom, 24 killed and at least 374 injured (Arab News). Foreign ministers of the UK, France, Germany, and Italy met Turkey, Saudi Arabia, Pakistan, and Egypt in Istanbul and urged restraint. Sat 24 OCT missiles toward Taif and Yanbu were intercepted, and debris fell in the Makkah region; the Houthis denied targeting the holy cities. Sun 25 OCT the coalition said it intercepted a ballistic missile and one or two drones toward Riyadh, a cruise missile toward Khamis Mushait, and 10 ballistic missiles toward the south; Riyadh's King Khalid airport reopened Terminals 1 and 2 for domestic and international flights after a two-week closure. Fresh 25 OCT: Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree claimed "three military operations with dozens of ballistic missiles" that hit the airport hours after it reopened, plus King Khalid Air Base at Khamis Mushait and a naval base in Jazan, and warned airlines that the airport "serves as a military target" (CBS/AFP); Riyadh had not confirmed any hit. Tolls for the 10 OCT airport attack still vary by outlet (13 to 17 dead, including one American). In Yemen, the Houthis say Saudi strikes killed 17; the Houthi-run health ministry told AP 9 died over two days. The UN says Taiz has been cut off for 20 days and water production has roughly halved. Reuters says Washington has rebuffed Saudi efforts to draw it in; US support is limited to targeting intelligence and aerial refueling (Al-Monitor). Fox reported Trump is weighing direct strikes on the Houthis; no decision has been announced.

US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	The Houthis are now hitting Saudi Arabia's oil heartland (Dammam, Dhahran, Shaybah) and aiming at Yanbu, the outlet of the pipeline that carries the oil diverted around Hormuz. A successful strike there would move oil prices more than anything in the strait this week. Americans in the kingdom face the risk the new advisory describes. Allies (the UK, Egypt, Turkey, Pakistan) are filling the defensive gap while the US holds back, which limits US exposure but also US control over escalation.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	Saudi coalition statements (al-Maliki on X; SPA); GACA; Saudi Energy Ministry; Arab News; The National; Anadolu; Al Arabiya; BBC; Reuters; AP; CBS/AFP (incl. fresh 25 OCT); UK MoD (GOV.UK); Mada Masr, Ahram Online, Parliament Gate; Al-Monitor; OCHA; Fox.
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	Daily Wire's Evening Wire led with "UK Air Force Launching Missions In Saudi Arabia"; Fox highlighted Britain's help and Trump weighing strikes. Most tracked right outlets did not cover the Saudi front this week.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	BBC and Reuters stressed civilian deaths and Yemen's displacement crisis; CBS and AFP stressed Yanbu's role in bypassing Hormuz and the Taiz siege; Arab News called it a "terror campaign" against the kingdom.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on Saudi-confirmed deaths, intercepts, and the airport reopening (official). MODERATE-HIGH on the Aramco evacuation (six sources; no company comment). LOW on Houthi target claims, including the 25 OCT airport claim. MODERATE on casualty totals (vary by outlet). HIGH that Egypt's vote is set for 26 OCT (no newer update found).

ITEM 5: US economy — significant economic events of the week: Brent +6% to $116.72; housing slump deepens; claims 194,000; flash PMI shows hottest prices since 2022; sentiment 48.0; S&P 500 −0.5% on the week (Significance: HIGH)

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	19–25 OCT. Energy: on Tue 20 OCT the expiring November WTI contract touched $110.48 and settled at $101.79; December Brent touched $111.99 and settled at $108.79. On Wed 21 OCT December WTI settled at $97.15 in its first day as front month. On Thu 22 OCT Brent settled at $113.17 (+4%). On Fri 23 OCT Brent settled at $116.72 (+3.14%, highest since 29 APR) and WTI at $103.27 (+3.8%). December Brent rose 6.2% on the week from $109.86 (computed from the archive's sourced settles); WTI weekly change is not comparable because the contract rolled. EIA (week to 16 OCT): crude −3.06 million barrels to 412.5 million, gasoline −2.95 million, distillates +1.68 million (first build in a while), refinery use 93.4%; SPR about 282.7 million barrels (Newsquawk). The IMF said oil would average $130 in 2027 if the disruption continues. Housing: NAHB builder confidence fell to 29 (lowest since June 2012; 19 OCT); September housing starts fell 5.2% to a 1.221 million annual rate, single-family −4.6% to 859,000, permits 1.400 million (Census, 20 OCT); NAR pending home sales fell 7.3% to 66, a series low (secondary); Freddie Mac's 30-year rate was 7.40% (15 OCT) and MBA's fell to 7.41% from 7.50%. Labor: initial claims fell 6,000 to 194,000 for the week ended 17 OCT; continuing claims 1.728 million (DOL, 22 OCT). Activity and prices: S&P Global's flash US Composite PMI slipped to 57.6 from 58.4, with hiring the fastest since June 2022 and selling prices rising at the fastest pace since August 2022 (23 OCT). UMich final October sentiment was 48.0 (September 48.1); 69% of consumers expect rates to rise. Markets: the S&P 500 fell 1.21% on 22 OCT (worst day since July) as the Nasdaq fell 2.60% on AI-spending fears (Meta −7% despite beating estimates; semiconductors −6.7% per SAAM Capital); the 10-year yield fell more than 17 bp to 4.972% that day in a flight to safety. Weekly (16 OCT to 23 OCT closes): S&P 500 7,659.44 → 7,623.68 (−0.5%), Nasdaq 26,140.03 → 25,955.34 (−0.7%), Dow 52,002.41 → 52,215.16 (+0.4%); the S&P energy sector hit a record. Policy: USDA announced an $8 billion "Harvest Fuel Relief" program for farmers' 2026 diesel and input losses (19 OCT); Energy Secretary Wright said the administration is "talking about reopening every refinery we can" and is converting idled "dark tankers" to carry only non-sanctioned oil; Trump signed a Defense Production Act Section 303 determination with up to $150 million for refinery restart and expansion (22 OCT; GasBuddy's De Haan: "I don't think that's really

going to have any impact"). The White House revised its 50% tariffs on Canada, effective 30 OCT. Corporate: United Airlines said fuel costs are up 62% from a year ago and cut its Q4 outlook; Tesla and Meta beat estimates; Audi chose the Middle Georgia Megasite for its first US plant (about $4 billion, 4,500 jobs, production by 2031). Fed: in blackout; FOMC 27–28 OCT, September PCE 29 OCT; CME FedWatch showed 84.5% odds of a hold (21 OCT, secondary), and a Reuters poll finds nearly all economists expect a hold (summary). Politics of prices: Reuters/Ipsos puts approval of Trump's handling of the economy at 36%. AAA national regular eased to $4.2892 (25 OCT) from $4.2988 a week earlier; national diesel rose to $6.3474 from $6.3224.

US IMPACT ASSESSMENT

The oil shock is now visible in producer-side price gauges (PMI selling prices) while the labor market holds, which argues against any Fed easing and keeps a December hike in play. Housing is the clearest domestic casualty. Gasoline drifted slightly lower on the week, but diesel, which drives Minnesota farm, freight, and heating costs, kept rising. The policy response (DPA money, refinery restarts, farm aid, Russian diesel) is slow or small next to $115+ Brent. Futures reopen Sunday evening after a weekend of strike talk.

SOURCE SYNOPSIS

CNBC; Reuters (via Investing.com, Euronext, EnergyNow); WSJ; AP; Newsquawk; Census Bureau (primary); NAHB (primary); DOL claims release; S&P Global (Williamson commentary); University of Michigan ISR; White House determination and DOE release; USDA release; CBS MoneyWatch; NBC; Audi and Georgia Governor releases; Seoul Economic Daily (FedWatch, NAR, Freddie Mac); NPR (IMF); AAA (25 OCT, primary).

MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)

The administration's frame is that oil will "drop like a rock" when the war ends and that it is helping farmers and refiners now; Bessent: "This is an energy shock" (Meet the Press, 18 OCT). BlazeTV aired a segment saying Democrats "have the stated goal of destroying the oil and gas industry"; Glenn Beck acknowledged more domestic production "hasn't solved that problem." No Blaze, Daily Wire, or Timcast coverage of the PMI or sentiment data was found.

MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)

CBS led on experts doubting the DPA ("There is no slack in U.S. refining," Tom Kloza); Reuters tied record diesel to voter discontent; CNBC and AP framed 22 OCT as an AI-spending scare plus an oil spike; the Guardian framed the five-month oil high as part of the "greatest energy supply disruption" in market history.

CONFIDENCE

HIGH on settles, closes, Census, DOL, PMI, UMich, AAA, and the DPA/USDA documents (primary or multiple outlets). MODERATE-HIGH on FedWatch, NAR, and Freddie Mac figures (secondary). HIGH on weekly deltas (computed from the archive's sourced closes).

ITEM 6: Russia–Ukraine — Witkoff meets Putin, Hubbard freed; Abu Dhabi talks around 10 NOV; Kyiv hit by 21 missiles; Graham Act waiver and Russian diesel draw bipartisan fire; Oleshky ceasefire 27 OCT (Significance: MEDIUM–HIGH)

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

18–25 OCT. Trump's late-Friday (16 OCT) order waiving the Graham Act's new Russia tariffs and sanctions (a 60-day review, per Rubio) drew bipartisan criticism; with Congress in recess there is no quick counter (AP). Ukraine launched more than 1,000 drones at Russia on 18–19 OCT, setting St. Petersburg oil sites on fire. Trump (19–20 OCT): "it's time for somebody else to negotiate on behalf of Ukraine" and the US "got nothing back other than high diesel." Oslo, 20 OCT: Zelensky met Witkoff with Finland's and Norway's leaders; a US official called the talks "constructive," and Zelensky said US early warning "works now." St. Petersburg, 21 OCT: Witkoff met Putin for about three hours; Russia released Stephen Hubbard, 74, held since April 2022, and Trump wrote "There was no 'swap' necessary for this release." Ushakov said Russia is "in principle, ready to resume" trilateral talks "around the 10th of November," possibly in Abu Dhabi; Peskov later said the first half of November, and Zelenskyy confirmed technical talks then. Witkoff called Putin "a humanitarian," drawing "WTF, Steve?" from Sen. Tillis and "Putin is stone cold killer" from Sen. Cornyn; Majority Leader Thune: "Putin is a menace to the world." Overnight into 22 OCT Russia hit Kyiv with 21 ballistic missiles in

three waves, killing at least two and wounding 22; Zelenskyy mocked Russian "humanitarians." Starshield: the WSJ reported Musk ordered a slowdown of Ukraine's military Starlink service and later that Trump called Musk to reverse it; Trump said on 23 OCT "I have not spoken to him," then on 24 OCT said "I have, yeah" when asked if he had spoken to Musk about Ukraine. Diesel: Russian diesel cargoes initially went to Turkey and Brazil (Reuters); Moscow said on 23 OCT the first shipment under the US deal for 300,000 tonnes is headed to New York (Russian statement). The White House said First Lady Melania Trump brokered a humanitarian ceasefire in occupied Oleshky; Ukraine's ombudsman Lubinets says it now starts 27 OCT at 0300 Kyiv (2000 CDT Monday 26 OCT), earlier than the 29 OCT first announced, for about 1,700 civilians. The sides swapped 270 prisoners each. Zelenskyy said Russia launched about 1,600 guided bombs, 48 missiles, and nearly 2,300 drones in the past week and asked for more Patriots.

US IMPACT ASSESSMENT

The administration now has deliverables to point to before 03 NOV (Hubbard, a talks date, Oleshky), but Russia has offered process, not concessions, while getting sanctions relief. Russian diesel arriving in New York ties US fuel prices directly to that relief. Ukraine's Patriot requests compete with Gulf and Israeli demand for the same interceptors.

SOURCE SYNOPSIS

AP (Mascaro); Reuters; Washington Post; Axios (Ravid); Kremlin transcript; TASS; Guardian; NBC; BBC; Al Jazeera/AFP; Kyiv Post (Lubinets, 25 OCT); Factba.se transcripts; Anadolu; WSJ via Guardian/Reuters.

MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)

TheBlaze amplified "We've got nothing back, other than high diesel" and headlined "First lady Melania Trump successfully negotiates ceasefire"; Timcast News ran "America's obsession with Ukraine is getting OUT OF CONTROL!"; the sharpest right-of-center criticism came from GOP senators, not the tracked outlets.

MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)

NBC and the Guardian led on Republican senators breaking with the Putin outreach and on Kyiv being struck "hours after agreeing to peace talks"; the Guardian quoted European diplomats saying the US "appears to have switched sides."

CONFIDENCE

HIGH on the meetings, Hubbard's release, quotes, and the Kyiv strike. MODERATE on the 10 NOV date and venue ("in principle"). HIGH on the 27 OCT Oleshky start (Ukrainian official; matches Melania's date); MODERATE that it holds. MODERATE on the diesel shipment (Russian statement). MODERATE on the Starshield sequence (conflicting accounts).

ITEM 7: Domestic / Minnesota — Omar: "Ilhan Nur Said Elmi" filing, Fox "real name" report, Trump resignation call; still no charges; Klobuchar–Demuth debates; feds stop sharing Good/Pretti evidence (Significance: MEDIUM–HIGH)

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

19–25 OCT. Border Czar Homan said 19 OCT that Rep. Ilhan Omar could "of course" be denaturalized if evidence supports it; Obama condemned the comment. The NY Post (19–20 OCT, anonymous sources) reported prosecutors plan to use DNA evidence and that Omar's sister spoke with investigators. Trump, Oval Office 20 OCT: "She could be [deported]. She could also go to jail." On 21 OCT a DOJ filing asked the court to delay responding to 14 news organizations' unseal requests until the warrant for her DC home is fully executed, or until 09 NOV, and styled her "Ilhan Nur Said Elmi, a/k/a Ilhan Abdullahi Omar" (Daily Wire; filing not read). Omar: "We're not going to be intimidated"; she will move out of the DC home for safety (NBC, AP). On 22 OCT Fox News Digital (two sources) reported "Ilhan Omar" is not her real name; her office called it "completely false." Trump in Sioux City (22 OCT): she must "immediately have to resign from Congress"; he repeated it in Fort Myers (23 OCT). On 23 OCT Omar voted in Minnesota and posted "My name has always been Ilhan Omar"; she told Fox her name is "Ilhan Abdullahi Omar." A Washington Post FEC analysis found she raised $847,000 on 12 OCT and $665,000 on 13 OCT. No charges have been filed. At Perry, GA (24 OCT) Trump said "98% of the people we have here from Somalia don't work"; at a Michigan rally on 25 OCT (fresh, TheBlaze clip) he said "from Somalia, I've had it with them."

	Governor's race: Klobuchar (DFL) and Demuth (R) debated in Brainerd (19 OCT) and Rochester (21 OCT), centering on fraud, the gas tax, and the Iran war; the Star Tribune/KARE 11 poll (05–07 OCT) had Klobuchar 50%, Demuth 41%, and a later KSTP/SurveyUSA poll reportedly 48–41. Early voting reached about 202,000 ballots, about 17% above the same point in 2022 (secondary). Evidence dispute: Minnesota says the US attorney's office paused sharing evidence on the federal agents' killings of Renee Good and Alex Pretti on 10 SEP; the state asked a judge to order it turned over; no ruling found as of DTG.
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	The Omar case has moved from a sealed probe into the center of the national campaign, with the President calling for a resignation before any charge (removal would take a two-thirds House vote). DOJ's 09 NOV fallback date means the warrant record likely stays sealed through the election. The Good/Pretti dispute puts Minnesota and the federal government in court over who investigates federal agents' use of force.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	Daily Wire (DOJ filing); NY Post; White House pool reports; Fox News Digital; Iowa Capital Dispatch via KCCI; MPR News; NBC; AP; Washington Post (FEC analysis); Omar on X; TheBlaze clips (incl. 25 OCT Michigan); KAXE; Star Tribune; KSTP (summary); AP, PBS, Fox 9, CBS Minnesota (evidence dispute).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	Glenn Beck (22 OCT): the legal name "isn't Ilhan Omar. It's Ilhan Nur Said Elmi. Is she DONE?!"; Crowder repeated the claim that Omar married her brother ("We have the marriage certificate"); Timcast IRL: "Ilhan Omar IS A FAKE NAME Reports Fox, SHES COOKED"; Tim Pool: "It is a felony to file for office under a fake name"; Daily Wire: "Ilhan Omar Insists Her Name Has Always Been Ilhan Omar After DOJ Filing Raises Questions."
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	AP, NBC, and MPR led on Omar moving out for safety, the lack of charges, and DOJ's tradition of avoiding public steps against candidates near an election; the Washington Post led on her fundraising surge; Al Jazeera and The National stressed that Trump "attacks her Somali roots."
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on quotes, the vote, fundraising, and that no charges exist. HIGH that DOJ's filing uses the "a/k/a" styling (multiple reports; filing not read). LOW-MODERATE on Fox's and the NY Post's anonymous-source claims. MODERATE on the KSTP and early-vote figures.

ITEM 8: DOJ, courts, and the midterms — ex-FBI officials charged; Alaska certification suit ("I recommended it"); Ninth Circuit hears California ballot fight today; Fifth Circuit backs ICE detention; Israel votes 27 OCT (Significance: MEDIUM)

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	19–25 OCT. DOJ charged 28 legal permanent residents in California with illegally registering and voting (19 OCT); suspicious letters reached House offices (Reps. Subramanyam, Pingree) as the FBI investigated letters with an "unknown substance" sent to election offices. On 22 OCT DOJ's teased "major indictment" was a Utah synagogue-threat hate-crime case; DOJ also indicted a Virginia state senator in a marijuana-distribution case (name not confirmed here). On 23 OCT former FBI Foreign Influence Task Force officials Nikki Cole Floris and Bradley Benavides were charged by complaint with false statements to Congress over Hunter Biden testimony (USAO-DC). DOJ sued to block certification of Alaska's Senate race unless Sen. Dan Sullivan wins, citing a second "Daniel J. Sullivan Jr." on the ballot; Trump said 24 OCT, "I recommended it to the DOJ. They looked at it, they agreed with me." US Attorney Essayli's office sent letters to 57 California counties listing 1,133 "likely aliens" on voter rolls. The full Fifth Circuit ruled 10–7 that detainees held as "applicants for admission" are not entitled to bond hearings. Fresh 25 OCT: a Ninth Circuit panel (Bennett, Bumatay, Sanchez) heard remote argument at 1500 CDT on DOJ's emergency motion to segregate, not cancel, mail ballots from more than 20,000 people federal agencies flag as "highly likely" noncitizens, and on Los Angeles County's motion to dismiss; the district court (Judge Carter) has a hearing set for 27 OCT; LA County says a sample check found 1 in 4 on DOJ's list were US-born; California says it will seek en banc review if blocked (Election Law Blog order; DOJ

	motion; Democracy Docket; ABC). No ruling was found as of DTG. Campaign: Trump said he will have spent $400 million for Republicans by 03 NOV; he rallied in Kansas, South Carolina, Iowa, Florida, Georgia, and (25 OCT) Michigan against Senate nominee Abdul El-Sayed; Obama campaigned in Cleveland and Detroit. A Reuters poll put Trump's approval at 31%, a record low (via Guardian). The Hill reports about 26.97 million early ballots cast (summary). Cook moved the Ohio governor's race to Lean D after Ramaswamy's ad; Michigan GOP Senate candidate Mike Rogers said he would back a war powers resolution if the Iran war runs into January. Israel votes Tuesday 27 OCT after Trump's endorsement of Netanyahu; Vance said he is "not getting involved."
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	DOJ is now directly in election administration (Alaska certification, California ballot segregation, county letters) days before the vote, and the President's statement that he recommended the Alaska suit strengthens challenges that the litigation is political. A Ninth Circuit order could come before Election Day and go en banc. The FBI false-statements case is the "accountability" case the right has demanded, though § 1001 cases are hard to win.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	DOJ OPA and USAO-DC releases; NBC; Factba.se transcript; Ninth Circuit order via Election Law Blog; DOJ emergency motion and filings (Democracy Docket); ABC (25 OCT); Fifth Circuit opinion; Politico; Texas Tribune; Guardian; Washington Post; AP; TheBlaze clips; The Hill (summary).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	Timcast IRL: "FBI Agents ARRESTED, Charged With LYING To Congress About Hunter Biden Laptop"; TheBlaze called the Fifth Circuit ruling "the most consequential ruling yet" on deportations and asked why California says "trust us" on voter eligibility; Daily Wire's District Club discussed what it called two pollsters "exposed for fabricating midterm data" (not verified; see quarantine).
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	NBC cited experts calling the Alaska suit legally shaky and noted § 1001 charges are rare; Democracy Docket called the California appeal a "dangerous bid" to block vote counting; AP headlined Obama assailing "cruelty" from Trump and his allies.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on the DOJ actions, court orders, and quotes (primary or multiple outlets). HIGH that the Ninth Circuit argument was scheduled and DOJ filed; no outcome known at DTG. MODERATE on poll and early-vote figures (secondary).

MN / US COST SNAPSHOT

MN electricity (avg)	17.20¢/kWh residential, August 2026 — EIA Electric Power Monthly Table 5.6.A / Form 861-M (released 23 OCT 26; new month, replaces July's 17.45¢ in last weekly); US avg 18.16¢/kWh same month
MN gasoline (avg)	$4.1991/gal regular — AAA Minnesota as of 25 OCT 26 (week: $4.2665 on 18 OCT → $4.1991; −$0.0674; month ago $4.3708; year ago $2.8949); national AAA regular $4.2892/gal same day (from $4.2988 on 18 OCT; −$0.0096)
MN diesel (avg)	$6.2199/gal — AAA Minnesota as of 25 OCT 26 (week: $6.1775 on 18 OCT → $6.2199; +$0.0424; month ago $6.3255; year ago $3.6009); national AAA diesel $6.3474/gal 25 OCT (from $6.3224; +$0.0250)
MN beef (avg)	$7.253/lb all uncooked ground beef, September 2026 — Midwest Census Region urban (BLS via FRED APU0200FC1101, checked 25 OCT 26; August $7.317; no newer month); Midwest proxy, no MN-specific series
Gold (spot)	$3,996.90/troy oz — gold-api.com XAU/USD as of ~1519 CDT 25 OCT 26 (2026-10-25T20:19:11Z; weekend quote, unchanged since Friday); down from $4,166.10 on 18 OCT (−4.1%); COMEX gold ended Friday 23 OCT at $3,991.10, −4.05% on the week (Dow Jones via Morningstar) (Kitco/LBMA not pulled; proxy feed)

US national debt	$40,444,342,709,389.15 total public debt outstanding — Treasury Fiscal Data Debt to the Penny, record_date 2026-10-22 (latest row as of 25 OCT ~1520 CDT); up $56.0 billion from $40,388,317,675,071.91 on 15 OCT

LAST WEEK'S THREADS — STATUS

Egypt's vote on defending Saudi Arabia	not held 20 OCT; adjourned to 26 OCT.
Iran's reply to US "observations" on the seven-day plan	no deal; Iran says no talks until its conditions are met, while Baghaei says messages still pass via intermediaries.
"Finish the job" / Pickaxe Mountain / MOAB	no strike; post-midterm planning now reported by the NYT, NPR, ABC, and the FT.
UKMTO numbering past 177-26	now 181-26 (plus Advisory 178-26). Cape Dao status: no update found. CENTCOM blockade count (138 as of 17 OCT): no newer figure found; Cooper cites 3,000+ US-supported transits over six months.
Russian diesel vs the Meeks bill	first cargo reportedly bound for New York; Congress in recess. Trilateral summit: technical talks around 10 NOV in Abu Dhabi.
Omar unseal ruling	none; DOJ asked for until 09 NOV. Charges: none.

LOOKING AHEAD (week of 26 October – 1 November 2026)

1. Iran: whether "not today" holds through 03 NOV; the Theodore Roosevelt group and 13th MEU arrival; Pezeshkian–Putin in Moscow; any Qatari or Pakistani channel result; Israel's election Tue 27 OCT and coalition math.
2. Hormuz: UKMTO numbering past 181-26; Iran's "no US warships" line vs escort operations; any named ship in IRGC claims; Gem No. 2 cleanup; next JMIC update; cable threats.
3. Saudi/Yemen: Egypt's parliament vote (26 OCT); Riyadh airport operations after the 25 OCT Houthi claim; Yanbu and East-West pipeline; any US decision on striking the Houthis; Turkey's Mecca pact ratification.
4. Economy: futures reopen Sunday evening; FOMC decision Wed 28 OCT; September PCE 29 OCT; Canada tariff changes 30 OCT; Harvest Fuel Relief rates (November); DPA project selections; DOE ≤40 MMbbl SPR exchange award (still not found).
5. Russia/Ukraine: Oleshky ceasefire from 0300 Kyiv 27 OCT (2000 CDT 26 OCT); Abu Dhabi talks date; Russian diesel arrival; Graham Act waiver review.
6. Domestic: Ninth Circuit ruling and Judge Carter's 27 OCT hearing on California ballots; Alaska certification suit; Floris/Benavides proceedings; Omar warrant and unseal; MN Good/Pretti evidence ruling; MN early voting into the 03 NOV election.

GAPS / LIMITATIONS THIS RUN

Built from the seven dailies (19–25 OCT) plus fresh 25 OCT afternoon checks: CBS live updates with AP/AFP (Trump's Fox interview and "no strike today," Cooper, Baghaei, Houthi airport claim, Netanyahu video), the Al Jazeera live page (headline and summary only), The Hill and ABC strike-planning stories, UKMTO recent incidents via search (no warning past 181-26), Ninth Circuit filings and previews (no ruling found), AAA Minnesota and national pages, Treasury Debt to the Penny API, FRED, gold-api.com, and X feeds of TheBlaze, Daily Wire, Tim Pool, Glenn Beck, and Steven Crowder. S2 Underground had no posts found this week; Louder with Crowder framing comes from Steven Crowder's X account. The AP 25 OCT roundup timed out on direct fetch and was read through CBS's republication. The NYT strike-plan story and the WSJ carrier, Starshield, and memo pieces were read through other outlets. Flow figures (Kpler, AIS, Rubio, CENTCOM, Cooper, Aramco) measure different things and are not reconciled. FedWatch, NAR, and Freddie Mac figures are secondary. The Fed policy rate was not re-verified this run. The 10-year yield's Friday close was not captured. Electricity is August 2026; beef is a Midwest proxy; gold is a weekend proxy-feed quote, not Kitco/LBMA; the debt latest row is 22 OCT. Oil futures had not reopened at DTG. Iranian, IRGC, and Houthi claims are unverifiable in real time.

UNCONFIRMED / QUARANTINED

- IRGC claims of at least 13 ships hit or mined this week (18, 20, 22, and 24 OCT): no names, flags, or UKMTO matches; disputed by Trump and CENTCOM. Iran's 23 OCT claim that all non-permitted traffic has stopped.

- Iran's claims of a US strike on its Konarak naval base (a US official called it "inaccurate … as usual"), of downing an MQ-9 (20 OCT), and of downing a US LUCAS drone over Bandar Abbas (25 OCT): no US confirmation.
- Ambassador Moghadam's reported Hormuz-for-blockade-relief offer: reported by AP, denied by Iranian state media.

Houthi claims — strikes on the Saudi Defense Ministry, Yanbu, the East-West pipeline, and (25 OCT) Riyadh airport after reopening; a Saudi strike on an Indian yacht; Houthi death tolls from Saudi strikes.

- Erem News report that Trump is weighing Kharg Island strikes; Qatari mediators in Tehran (Al Jazeera headline only; an earlier Qatari-delegation report was denied by an IRGC-affiliated outlet).
- Flight-tracking reports of Russian Il-76 evacuations of Rosatom staff from Bushehr; X summaries of a Munir "ultimatum," "Mosaic Defense" activation, a "father of all bombs," and a Qatar/Pakistan "preliminary agreement."
- X posts claiming Hormuz reopens "tomorrow" and gas falls to $2.50: no source; treat as false.
- Fox's and the NY Post's anonymous-source claims about Omar's name and DNA evidence; the long-running claim repeated by Crowder, Timcast, and Trump that Omar married her brother (denied; not established by any court or charge; a first-term inquiry reportedly "yielded insufficient evidence").
- Daily Wire and Timcast claims that two pollsters were "exposed for fabricating midterm data": firms and evidence not verified here.

Trump's claim that Iran's inflation is 301% — not checked against a data source.